

Hasinee Atigala

Urban & Regional Planner · Comprehensive Plans · Sustainability · GIS

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Summary

Urban and regional planner with nearly a decade of experience in **strategic planning, plan-making, and stakeholder engagement** across the United States and Sri Lanka, currently coordinating **disaster-resilient resettlement planning with UN-Habitat**. Trained at Ball State University (MURP, 3.9 GPA) and the University of Moratuwa. National **Planning Excellence** award recipient. Member of the American Planning Association and chartered with the Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka.

Skills

Planning	Strategic Planning, Comprehensive Plan-Making, Land Use, Resiliency Planning, Sustainability Programs
Engagement	Stakeholder Engagement, Public Outreach, Plan Adoption Process, Grant Writing
Policy & Research	Regulatory Frameworks, Policy Analysis, Field Research
Technical	GIS Mapping, Cartography, Adobe Suite, MS Office
Languages	English, Sinhala

Experience

Town & Country Planner — UN-Habitat, Sri Lanka (Nuwara Eliya) *Jul 2026 – Present*

- Work within an integrated UN–Government program (UN-Habitat, UNOPS, IOM, NBRI), coordinating with government agencies, local authorities, and communities on disaster-resilient resettlement and recovery.
- Conduct planning studies for active resettlement sites in Nuwara Eliya District, integrating site assessments, community consultations, and disaster and climate risk analysis into resilient settlement planning.
- Develop GIS-based spatial planning outputs: site demarcation reports, base maps, community hazard and risk maps, physical layout plans, and prioritized adaptation maps.

Senior Planner — Madison County Council of Governments, Indiana, USA *Jun 2025 – Jun 2026*

- Led the 2026 Clean Air Aware Program for Madison County, owning outreach strategy, public engagement, and partner coordination to advance regional air-quality goals.
- Contributed research, analysis, and policy drafting to the Anderson Metropolitan Planning Area Resiliency Plan 2050.
- Wrote grant narratives, funding justifications, and project scope for the Markleville Community Park Trail Project.
- Served as the bridge between regional planners, municipal officials, and community partners to translate plan priorities into local action.

Planning Intern — Madison County Council of Governments, Indiana, USA *May 2023 – May 2024*

- Worked the Markleville Comprehensive Plan 2035 and the Integrate I-69 Corridor Study end-to-end – from background research through public hearings and adoption.
- Drafted analysis chapters, produced maps and visualizations, and ran digital public-outreach campaigns.
- Continued from the summer internship into a year-long placement supported by Ball State University's Department of Urban Planning.

Town Planner — Urban Development Authority, Sri Lanka *Sep 2019 – May 2024*

On study leave Aug 2022 – May 2024 for graduate study in the U.S.

- Authored Comprehensive and Strategic Plans for multiple local authorities, turning national policy into workable land-use frameworks.
- Designed mixed-method field research – document review, interviews, surveys, site assessments – to ground each plan in local conditions.

- Advised municipal officials on project feasibility, trade-offs, and cost-effectiveness throughout plan implementation.
- Produced the maps, charts, and visual analysis that anchored stakeholder presentations and public meetings.

Assistant Planning Officer — Urban Development Authority, Sri Lanka

Mar 2017 – Sep 2019

- Drafted Comprehensive and Strategic Plans balancing development against ecological constraints in environmentally sensitive zones.
- Authored technical reports and presented findings to senior planning leadership.

Project Coordinator — Eco-Friendly Volunteers, Sri Lanka

Jan 2016 – Mar 2017

- Delivered the U.S. Embassy-funded “Climate Change and Conscious Consumerism” initiative – coordinating three youth teams across major Sri Lankan cities and running nationwide awareness campaigns.

Education

Master of Urban & Regional Planning — Ball State University, Muncie, Indiana, USA

2022 – 2025

3.9 / 4.0 GPA · Graduate Assistantship · Dissertation: *The Social Production of the Lived “Para” – Urban Roads as Sites of Commerce, Culture, and Everyday Life in Sri Lanka*

B.Sc. (Hons) Town & Country Planning — University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

2009 – 2014

3.43 / 4.0 GPA · Dissertation: *Road as a Place – Place Characteristics of Station Roads in Sri Lanka*

Honors & Awards

- **Planning Excellence** (National Award) — Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka, 2022, for the Ratnapura Development Plan.
- **Graduate Assistantship Recipient** — Ball State University, Department of Urban Planning, for 2022–2023 and 2023–2024 academic years.

Professional Development

- **APA National Conferences** — Detroit 2026, Minneapolis 2024; **APA Indiana Chapter** — Fall 2025 (South Bend), Spring 2026 (Muncie).
- **ACSP Pre-Doctoral Workshop** — selected participant in 2023 and 2024.
- **JICA Japan** — “Urban Management for Sustainable Urban Development” knowledge co-creation program, 2021 (Sri Lankan Representative).
- Ongoing Continuing Professional Development through the Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka.

Professional Memberships

American Planning Association (APA) — Member ID 411124 · Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka (ITPSL) — Chartered Town Planner, Member ID M422

References

Available upon request.